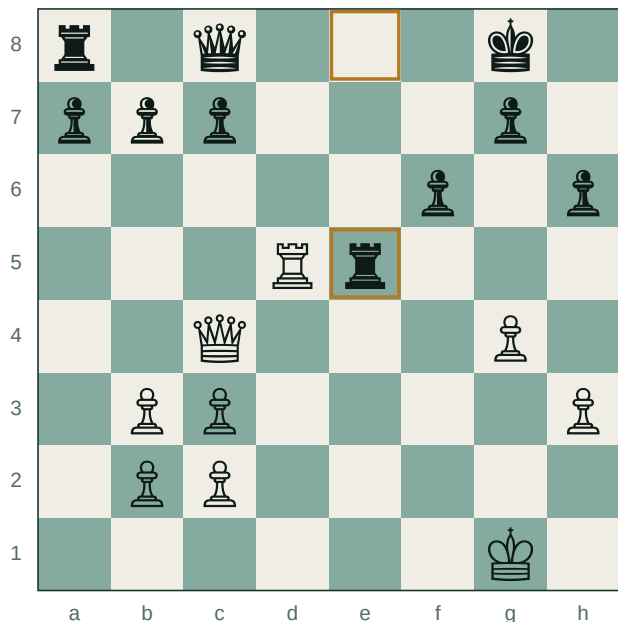


Double checks: White, move 22

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 21...Rxe5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22. Rd8+ Kh7 23. Qg8+ Kg6 24. Rxc8 Rxc8 25. Qxc8

22.Rd8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From d8 it attacks king on g8 and queen on c8. Recorded reply: **22...Kh7**.

23.Qg8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **23...Kg6**.

24.Rxc8 The rook captures the queen on c8. Recorded reply: **24...Rxc8**.

25.Qxc8 The queen captures the rook on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -5 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.